1. POLICY STATEMENT:

_____ encourages employee to return to work as soon as possible following a consecutive leave of absence; including an employee's own medical leave either FMLA or non-FMLA, personal, military, Short Term Disability, Long Term Disability and those related to Workers' Compensation.

2. PURPOSE:

This policy describes the process for assisting employees who are returning to work following a leave of absence status for a period of time, ensuring that all requirements have been met prior to their return. The process ensures access to the timekeeping system upon an employee's return.

3. SCOPE:

This policy applies to all _____ its wholly owned or controlled subsidiaries.

4. DEFINITIONS:

a. Return to Work ("RTW"): Process for employee who have been off work for an extended, consecutive period of time to provide the documentation to return and ensure that all compliance criteria have been met.

b. Leave of Absence ("LOA"): Period of time that an employee may be away from their job due to medical, military or personal reasons.

c. Family Medical Leave Act ("FMLA"): Federally mandated program to ensure that employee are provided time off for personal medical issues or family care needs. May be consecutive period of time or intermittent.

5. PROCEDURE:

To reinstate for duty, the return-to-work status/form from the treating provider is provided at least 48 hours prior to the anticipated return to work date.

a. Medical Leave of Absence – consecutive (FMLA or Non FMLA)

(1) Employee who have an absence lasting three or more days, have had any surgical procedure, need to use a therapeutic device, or have been hospitalized are required to obtain a release from their treating provider and to contact their _____

(2) When a release arrives without prior contact with _____, the employee is contacted for further information.

(3) _____ evaluates the reason for the absence, the employee's current condition, and the current release to determine if an exam at an authorized Occupational and Environmental Medicine Clinic ("OEM") is required for reinstatement.

(4) If no further information is necessary, _____ reinstates the employee.

(5) If _____ determines the employee needs to be seen at OEM, the referral is made and _____ provides a copy of the release from the treating provider to the appropriate OEM.

(6) The OEM clinic provides the return-to-work status to _____, who initiates the reinstatement.

(7) If there are restrictions, the return-to-work status indicates the specific restrictions, the duration, and the next visit to either the personal or OEM provider – depending on who provided the restriction.

(8) The employee's manager evaluates whether the listed restrictions can be accommodated for the duration indicated.

(9) Evaluation for potential Transitional Duty (TD) assignments occurs at this time.

(10) If an employee is released with permanent restrictions, _____ complies with the requirements under the American with Disabilities Act Amendment Act.

b. Personal Leave of Absence

(1) This is granted at the discretion of the employee's manager and may be FMLA or non FMLA.

(2) Employee contacts their manager when a return-to-work date is known to allow sufficient time for the necessary requirements to be accomplished.

c. Military Leave of Absence

(1) Usually accompanied by a set of military orders which verifies the dates (or anticipated dates) that the employee is needed for military duties.

(2) May have discharge papers or release from current assignment orders.

d. All checklists for return to work from any leave are sent to the centralized point at:

_____